

Gil Strauss

Chief Technology Officer · VP R&D · Chief Architect

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Profile

I build the engineering organizations behind mission-critical systems, without ever leaving the code. Over fourteen years at one company I took a B2B SaaS platform from greenfield to hundreds of millions of daily transactions, built the group that ran it, and drove it to DORA-elite performance. In the same period I took as much as a quarter out of cloud spend while volume rose. Today I am doing the same work in a different domain: legacy modernization and culture change at an EdTech company whose products reach over 1M K-12 students in Israel. I review architecture and code, write the specs for the hard problems, and build alongside coding agents.

Experience

Chief Technology Officer | Center for Educational Technology (CET) Tel Aviv · Aug 2025 – Present
Israel's leading independent EdTech company. Architect-strategist CTO across the platform portfolio.

- Co-designed an LLM-based content classification and analysis pipeline, and shipped educational features built on RAG, tool use, and MCP.
- Driving organization-wide adoption of spec-driven development and AI-augmented engineering practice, with a measurement framework to track it.
- Setting software and cloud architecture direction, moving legacy platforms toward a cloud-native, distributed architecture on Azure.

CTO & VP R&D | CG Solutions / Groove Technologies

Israel · 2011 – 2025

Promoted to CTO & VP R&D in 2012.

B2B SaaS for the regulated real-money gaming sector, running at 99.99% availability.

- **Two people to sixty.** Built it across R&D, DevOps, IT, NOC, and Product: five functions, four sites in Israel and Europe, five direct reports at peak.
- **Six-year transformation.** DORA-elite engineering performance, measured continuously via Haystack.
- **Greenfield to mission-critical.** Architected and scaled the platform on AWS from the first line of code, then migrated a monolithic architecture to a microservices mesh without availability impact.
- **Cost ownership.** Owned a cloud infrastructure budget reaching USD 1.2M annually across AWS, MongoDB Atlas, and ClickHouse Cloud, and reduced it by up to 25% through sustained FinOps work.

Earlier Roles

Software Team Leader, DoubleVerify · 2010–2011 · Software Engineer, Equitick · 2009–2010 · Team Leader, Microsoft Israel · 2008–2009 · Software Engineer, Oasis Capital Management · 2005–2008 · Team Leader, SeaPass Solutions · 2002–2004

Technical Skills

Architecture & Platform: Distributed systems · Microservices · Event-driven design · High-volume scalability · DDD · DORA · CI/CD · AI-augmented SDLC · FinOps

Cloud, Data & AI: AWS · Azure · Kubernetes · Terraform · Kafka · ClickHouse · MongoDB · Agentic systems · LLM integration · RAG · MCP · Coding agents · Python · Go · C#

Education

B.Sc., Information Systems Engineering · Technion — Israel Institute of Technology · 1998–2002

Military Service

Investigations Officer, IDF Military Police · 1993–1997 · Led a team of 30.